COLORADO

Chief Information Officer & Executive Director

Governor's Office of Information Technology

Enterprise IT Change Management Policy

Document ID	POL-OIT-001
Title	Enterprise IT Change Management Policy
Executive Sponsor	David Edinger, Chief Information Officer & Executive Director
Issuing Authority	Governor's Office of Information Technology (OIT)
Applies to	All classified and non-classified employees within OIT, including full- or part-time permanent and temporary employees, independent contractors, volunteers, and interns, regardless of physical work location.
Instrument Type	Policy
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1. Purpose

The Governor's Office of Information Technology (OIT) is charged with managing and supporting information technology for the executive branch. This includes the IT infrastructure as well as the systems and applications that state agencies rely upon to serve Colorado's residents, businesses, and/or visitors. Effective IT change management is integral to provide a stable environment and minimize disruptions to customers and IT services.

2. Policy

OIT shall manage changes in a planned, predictable, and well-communicated manner that minimizes unplanned downtime and unforeseen issues. All changes made to production systems and applications managed or maintained by OIT shall be made in accordance with the processes and procedures established by OIT's technical change management team and documented in the Standard Operating Procedure as posted on OIT Plaza.

3. Applicability

This policy applies to all classified and non-classified employees within OIT including full or part-time permanent and temporary employees, independent contractors, volunteers, and interns, regardless of physical work location.

4. References

- Enterprise IT Change Management SOP

5. Definitions

- ServiceHub: The Enterprise Change Management tool of record used for the tracking and approval of all changes in the production environment.
- Change: The addition, modification, or removal of approved, supported, or baselined hardware, network, software, application, environment, or systems.
- IT Change Management (CM): Refers to the formal process for making controlled changes to IT services and systems in a production environment.
- CM Users: All classified and non-classified employees within OIT including full or part-time permanent and temporary employees, independent contractors, volunteers, and interns who have access to the Change module in the CA tool.
- ITIL: Information Technology Infrastructure Library.
- Pending: An RFC is in the approval process, but is not yet Approved for implementation.
- Priority 1 Incident: An incident ticket tracked within ServiceHub deemed to be the highest priority based upon the established Service Desk Priority Matrix.
- Rejected: Request for Change has been denied and will not proceed.
- Request for Change (RFC): A request that is submitted for desired changes to an Information Technology Service environment using ServiceHub, also known as a Change Request.
- Risk/Impact: The assessed threat to Production availability of any service involved or impacted by a Change. Risk and impact are determined based on an assessment completed during the RFC submission process.
- Rollback: Any action in which all or part of a change is reverted to the previous state as a result of unforeseen problems or circumstances.
- Rollback Plan: Documented procedure for rolling back all or part of any change activity, including risks, dependencies, and required timeframe. This is appended to the RFC and may be a requirement for approval.
- Test Plan/Result: Documented evidence of proper testing, planning, and due diligence performed prior to submission of an RFC. This is appended to the RFC and may be a requirement for approval.
- Unauthorized Change: Any change that proceeds or is implemented without following the IT Change Management process; any Change implemented without all necessary levels of approval will be considered an Unauthorized Change.
- Violation: Any deviation from established policy or procedure will result in a Change violation and may prevent the implementation of the proposed change.

6. Standards

This policy applies to changes to a service or system that is in production in the OIT or customer agency environment. It does not replace the project management process, though it may be one step in that process.

OIT's IT Change Management process is, and shall continue to be, based on ITIL best practices.

7. Responsibilities

Before implementing a change, all Users are required to follow the Enterprise IT Change Management Standard Operating Procedure CCO-SOP-100.

Roles and responsibilities are further defined in the Enterprise IT Change Management Standard Operating Procedure CCO-SOP-100.

8. Compliance

Failure to comply with this policy may result in corrective action or disciplinary action, up to and including termination, as follows:

1st Violation

- Loss of access to the Change module with the ITSM Tool. Access will not be reinstated until the user undergoes IT Change Management training again.
- Email sent to the user's immediate supervisor and Director over the user's team.

2nd Violation

- Loss of access to the Change module with the ITSM Tool. This access will not be reinstated until the user undergoes IT Change Management training again.
- Referral to the immediate supervisor for progressive corrective or disciplinary actions.
- Email sent to the user's immediate supervisor, Director, Executive staff member over the user's team, and Human Resources.

Additional Violations

- May result in additional corrective or disciplinary action as determined by the user's supervisor and Human Resources, up to and including termination of employment.